MANALIVE EXPEDITION

THE JOURNEY

WEEK 6
A BATTLE TO FIGHT

DO YOUR JOB

DRAFT FOR REVIEW

October 12, 2026

WEEK 6 OVERVIEW

WHAT THIS WEEK IS FOR

Week 6 walks a man back through Saturday morning's Battle session, so he can use what he learned there on an ordinary Tuesday afternoon. Day 40 carries When the Battle Goes Dark, the session on suicide and staying with a brother. By Sunday he should be able to say:

> *There is a real battle, and I don't have to be obsessed with the enemy to see it. He comes at me through messages: accusation, diminishment, his spin on what happened. A wound and a message are not the same thing. An agreement is when I accept a false message as true and start living from it. I can learn to catch those. I have authority in Christ to stop agreeing with them. I know what to do: Recognize, Break Agreement, Ask for Truth, Listen. I don't have to keep running. I can turn around.*

HOW EVERY DAY WORKS

READING	About 150 words. A quick reminder of what happened at camp and where it shows up at home.
AUDIO	About 2 minutes from John. A handle to carry, one layer deeper, and a story.
WITH DAD	5 minutes on weekdays this week. Saturday is 10, a short version of the Battle Covenant of Silence. Sunday stays at 3.
SHARE	Optional. Opens the alumni group with his thought ready to paste.
NOTES	Private. Day 42 shows him this week's notes in one place.
WEEKLY EMAIL	Sunday evening. One heart line per day.

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY	TITLE	CARRY THIS	WITH DAD
36 · Mon	We Are at War	**Do your job**	5 min
37 · Tue	Real Event, False Spin	**Real event. False spin.**	5 min
38 · Wed	Robert Sat Down	**Sounds like me. Isn't me.**	5 min
39 · Thu	Break It Out Loud	**Recognize. Break. Ask. Listen.**	5 min
40 · Fri	When the Battle Goes Dark	**Stay calm. Stay normal. Stay close.**	5 min
41 · Sat	Beginning to Believe	**He doesn't get to name me**	10 min
42 · Sun	Again Next Tuesday	**Again next Tuesday**	3 min

WE ARE AT WAR

READING

Saturday morning started with three trailers, back to back. Tears of the Sun. Fury. The Matrix.

Nobody had to explain them. The room got quiet in a different way.

Something is at stake. You have a role. Wake up.

Then the weekend turned. Friday was about what happened to your heart. Saturday said there's been another voice in that story the whole time, telling you what it all meant.

There's a real enemy. He comes to steal, kill, and destroy. Ignoring him doesn't get you out of the fight. It just means you fight it asleep.

And hear this too: we're not getting spooky. Nobody's hunting demons behind the couch. This isn't about fear. It's about clarity.

This week we walk back through that session. You learned a way to fight. You're going to use it.

Fury said it in three words. Do your job.

> **CARRY THIS**
> **Do your job.**

AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Let me tell you what I think that line means, because it can go sideways fast.
>
> In Fury, somebody's yelling it over the noise of the fight. Do your job. And a lot of us hear that and think, okay. Try harder. Grit your teeth. Be a better man by Friday.
>
> That's not it.
>
> Your job isn't to become some spiritual commando. Your job isn't to chase the devil around your house. Your job is your heart. Above all else, guard your heart. Keep it. Fight for it.
>
> Because here's the thing about this war. You don't get to opt out. You can ignore it. Plenty of men do. They figure life is hard, they're tired, and that's just how it is. But ignoring a fight doesn't mean you're not in one. It means you're losing ground and don't know why.

Now, not everything bad is the enemy. The world's broken. People make choices. Bodies get sick. Sometimes you fall off a ladder because you fell off a ladder.

But right after the bad thing, there's another voice. Telling you what it means. What it says about you. That's where the fight is. Not out there somewhere. In here. Over what you believe.

So this week we get practical. Saturday morning you were handed a way to fight, simple enough to use on a Tuesday afternoon. We're going to walk it again.

So here's what I want you to carry today. Do your job.

Not hustle. Not fear. Just pay attention to your heart today. Notice when something lands heavy. Notice what you start telling yourself about it.

Then take it to Dad. Ask Him where the fight is.

Do your job. Your job is your heart.

WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Ask Him: *Father, where is the fight in my life right now?* Then listen. If nothing comes, that's okay. Tell Him you're paying attention, and sit with Him anyway.

SHARE

Tears of the Sun, Fury, or The Matrix: which trailer woke you up Saturday morning?

YOUR NOTES

REAL EVENT, FALSE SPIN

READING

Remember the three words from Saturday morning? Wound. Message. Agreement.

The wound is what happened to your heart. The message is what you heard, or came to believe, through what happened. The agreement is when you accept that message as true and start living from it.

They're not the same thing. That matters.

Here's how it plays out. Your marriage is struggling. That's real. Then a message shows up: *You're a terrible husband.* Agree with it, and it becomes: *I'm a terrible husband. I always screw this up.* Now you're living from it. You quit trying. Or you try way too hard.

The event can be real. The pain can be real. Even the failure can be real. The accusation attached to it can still be a lie.

This week, start noticing the second voice. The one that shows up right after something happens and tells you what it means about you.

You don't have to fight it yet. Just catch it.

> **CARRY THIS**
> **Real event. False spin.**

AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Try something today. Next time something goes wrong, listen for what you hear right after.
>
> Not the event. The commentary.
>
> Let me give you one of mine.
>
> For about three years, I worked with anti-trafficking organizations and spoke all over the country. I believed in that message with everything in me. And over and over, people would come up afterward and say, I'd love to do more with you.
>
> And then nobody followed up. Year after year.

By the end, the voice was loud and clear. Nobody wants to hear what you have to say. What you have to say just isn't important.

Here's the tricky part. Some of that was real. I didn't get hired the way I thought I would. The event was real. But the meaning I attached to it? That I didn't matter? That was the spin. And it sounded like me. It sounded like the truth.

That's how this works. Most of the time the enemy doesn't have to cause the thing. Life does that on its own. He just shows up afterward with his spin. He tells you what it means. And most of us have been taking his word for it for years.

Here's the difference that changes everything. The wound is what happened. The message is what you were told it means. Two different things. You can't change what happened. But you don't have to keep believing what you were told about it.

So here's what I want you to carry today. Real event. False spin.

When something hits today, and something will, let it be real. Don't pretend it didn't hurt. Then ask one question. Who's telling me what this means?

You don't have to fix it today. Thursday we'll walk through how you fight it. Today, just catch it.

Then take it to Dad. Ask Him what He says it means. He has a version too. And His is true.

Real event. False spin.

WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Think of one thing from the last few days that still stings. Ask Him: *Father, what did I tell myself this means about me?* Then: *What do You say it means?* Listen. If it isn't clear yet, that's okay. You're learning to tell the voices apart.

SHARE

Where does the spin sneak in on ordinary days? (Running late turns into "I'm always a screwup.") No details needed.

YOUR NOTES

ROBERT SAT DOWN

READING

Remember Robert the Bruce and his father?

Robert's heart is on fire. He's watched William Wallace fight, and he wants in. Then his father talks to him. Calm. Reasonable. Survive. Play it safe. Compromise. *"Uncompromising men are easier to admire."*

And you watch Robert start to give his heart away.

That's how the enemy works most days. Not with horns. With a voice that sounds wise. Or that sounds like you.

At camp we named his two favorite moves.

Accusation. Look what you did. You're disqualified. If these guys really knew you.

Diminishment. You don't have what it takes. You're too old. It's too late. Sit down. Stay safe.

After the clip came two questions. What did Robert agree with? And where does that happen in me?

You don't need a long list. You probably already know which one gets you.

> CARRY THIS
> **Sounds like me. Isn't me.**

AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Here's a trick the enemy loves. He throws a thought at you. And then he blames you for having it.
>
> You're in a meeting and something petty pops into your head about the guy across the table. And right behind it: what kind of man thinks that? Two hits. One setup.
>
> Most of us never stop to ask where that first thought came from. We just take the beating.
>
> So which one gets me? Let me be honest with you.
>
> For me, it's accusation. And I'll tell you where it hits.

Some guys kicked porn years ago and haven't looked back. That's not my story. I've worked on it for years. Tried a lot of things. And there have been stretches where I stopped working on it and just said, this is part of my life.

I'm open about it. People know. But when I fall today, there's still a voice. Here you are again. You're never going to kick this. This just proves you're not serious about changing.

For a long time I didn't know that was a voice. I thought it was just me. The truth about me that everybody else was too nice to say.

That's what happened to Robert. His father didn't drag him anywhere. He just talked. And by the end, Robert thought it was his own good sense.

So here's what I want you to carry today. Sounds like me. Isn't me.

When that voice shows up today, it'll use your voice. First person. I'm such an idiot. I'm too old for this. I always blow it. That's the giveaway.

You don't have to win the argument. Just notice it isn't yours. Call it what it is. That's accusation. That's diminishment.

And remember, Robert's story didn't end in that room. He got back up. Yours doesn't end there either.

Then turn to Dad. Ask Him where you sat down. And ask Him what He'd say instead.

Sounds like me. Isn't me.

WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Ask Him: *Father, where have I sat down like Robert?* Then: *What did I agree with?* Listen. No beating yourself up. Seeing it is the win today.

SHARE

Accusation or diminishment: which one gets you more?

YOUR NOTES

BREAK IT OUT LOUD

READING

Saturday morning you were handed a way to fight. Simple enough to use on a Tuesday afternoon.

Recognize the message. What am I hearing?

Find the agreement. Where have I accepted this as true?

Break it out loud. *"I break the agreement that _____."*

Ask Jesus for truth. *"Jesus, what is the truth?"*

Listen. Shut up long enough to hear. Write down what comes.

Out loud isn't magic. There's no secret formula in the words. But something happens when a man names what he's believed and says plainly, *I don't agree with that anymore.*

It takes courage. Remember Robin Hood? Rise and rise again. Breaking an agreement that feels true is about as brave as a man gets.

And the authority is real. It's Christ's, and He gave it to you as His son.

Some agreements break the first time. Some have been around for decades. You keep going.

CARRY THIS

Recognize. Break. Ask. Listen.

AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> This is the one I most want you to have. So let me show you, not just tell you.
>
> I'll be honest with you. I don't have one big line-in-the-sand moment. No dramatic before and after.
>
> What I have is a habit. I break agreements all the time. Out loud. I break the agreement that I'm a failure. I break the agreement that no one loves me. I break the agreement that I'm a bad friend. I break the agreement that I don't know how to love my wife.
>
> It's become a normal part of my life. Like brushing my teeth.

And some of them have lost their grip. For years I believed nobody wanted to hear what I had to say. Today I lead sessions at ManAlive, and I love it. I'm good at it. That voice got quieter every time I kept showing up.

Others, I'm still wrestling with. "I'm a failure" still comes around. So I break it again. Then I ask Him what's true. Then I get quiet long enough to hear.

And here's what I want you to know. Breaking an agreement once doesn't mean the voice never comes back. It might. The difference is, now you know what it is. And you know what to do with it.

That's the goal. Not a man who never gets hit. A man who knows how to fight back.

So here's what I want you to carry today. Recognize. Break. Ask. Listen.

Try it today. Not on the biggest thing in your life. Start with one. Something that showed up this week. The voice that said you're behind. You always blow it. Nobody notices what you do.

Name it. Say it out loud, in your truck if you have to. I break the agreement that I always blow it. Then ask, Jesus, what's the truth? And then stop talking.

If you don't hear anything right away, that's okay. Some of these have been around a long time. Write down what you broke. Come back to it tomorrow.

Recognize. Break. Ask. Listen. Go do it with Dad.

WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Pick one. Just one. Say it out loud: *I break the agreement that _____*. Then ask: *Jesus, what is the truth?* Listen, and write down what comes. If nothing comes yet, write down what you broke. That counts.

SHARE

Did you break one today? Just post "Broke one." No details needed.

YOUR NOTES

WHEN THE BATTLE GOES DARK

READING

Right after the Battle session at camp, we talked about something most men never say out loud. Suicide.

You watched Tyson Fury. The heavyweight champion of the world was thinking about suicide, and the people looking at him could not see the fight happening inside him. Strength didn't make him immune. Neither did success, or people who loved him. He needed help, and help came.

Men like us can struggle with this. Men who work, provide, laugh, and show up. You're allowed to say the word. And you can tell somebody.

If you're worried about a brother, ask him straight: *Are you thinking about suicide?* You don't have to fix him. Ask, and stay.

If it's you, don't wait. You don't need a speech. "I need to talk" is enough. Tell one person today.

Call or text **988**, the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (in the US), any time, day or night. If you might act on it right now, call 988 or 911, or get to someone near you.

[Link: ManAlive suicide resources page, coming]

Your story doesn't have to end here.

> CARRY THIS
> **Stay calm. Stay normal. Stay close.**

AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> I'm going to say a word today that a lot of men never say out loud. Suicide.
>
> I'm not saying it for shock. I'm saying it because the silence is part of what makes it so heavy. A man carries it and thinks he's the only one. So he doesn't say it. And he carries it alone.
>
> Men like us can struggle with this. It's not weakness. It's not a lack of faith. It's a battle that went dark.

So if that's you, now or before, you can tell somebody. Call or text 988. Tell one of the guys. "I need to talk" is enough.

And if you're worried about a brother, here's what we learned at camp. Ask. Stay. Safe. Connect. Follow.

Ask him straight. Are you thinking about suicide? Saying the word doesn't put the idea in his head. It gives him permission to answer.

If he says yes, stay. Thank you for telling me. I'm here. Keep talking. Don't panic. Don't preach. You don't have to fix him.

Help him stay safe. If he might be in danger right now, stay with him and bring help in. Call 988 together.

Connect. Brotherhood doesn't replace professional help. It makes sure he doesn't have to find it by himself.

And follow up. Tomorrow matters. Call him. Take him to breakfast. Ask again.

So here's what I want you to carry today. Stay calm. Stay normal. Stay close.

If he tells you, he's still your brother. He's the same guy he was thirty seconds before he trusted you.

Take it to Dad today. Ask Him who He wants you to check on. And if it's you, tell Him. Then tell a person.

Help can come into the story. The story keeps going.

WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Ask Him: *Father, who do You want me to check on?* Then listen, and text that man today. If you're the one carrying something heavy, tell Dad that too. Then tell a person. You weren't meant to carry it alone.

SHARE

Text one guy today: "Hey, how are you really doing?" Then post that you did. No names.

YOUR NOTES

BEGINNING TO BELIEVE

READING

The last clip Saturday morning was the subway. Neo has been running the whole movie. Then he stops. He turns around.

The fight is brutal. He gets hit. Hard. And the whole time, the agent keeps calling him *Mr. Anderson*. The old name. The small one.

Then Morpheus says it: *"He's beginning to believe."*

Believe what? Who he is.

That's the fight. Not a man who never gets hit. A man who's stopped letting the enemy name him. Getting hit again doesn't mean your freedom failed.

Remember the hour right after the session? The Covenant of Silence. Alone with God, breaking agreements, asking for truth, writing it down.

Today you get a short version of that hour. Ten minutes. Find a quiet place. Bring a pen.

You don't have to keep running. You can turn around.

> **CARRY THIS**
> **He doesn't get to name me.**

AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Let me tell you about a time I turned around.
>
> Early on, when I was first starting to come out of my sex addiction, I was still full of insecurity. And one night I went out to a bar and slept with a woman.
>
> I had to go back and tell my band of brothers. And they were encouraging. They talked it through with me. Okay. A mistake. It happens.
>
> Then a week later, I did the exact same thing. And I had to tell them again.
>
> That second time was so much harder. All the old voices poured back in. You're a failure. You always screw up. You're always going to do something wrong.

But I went back and told them anyway. Were they frustrated? Sure. Did they challenge me? Absolutely. But they didn't leave. And facing it with them forced me to look at what was really going on.

That's where I learned I could open up. It still feels risky. But I learned I was safe with those guys. They knew me. And they loved me, in spite of my mistakes.

Here's what I notice in that subway scene every time. Neo doesn't win because he stops getting hit. He gets hit plenty. He wins because something changed in what he believes about himself.

The agent keeps saying it. Mr. Anderson. Mr. Anderson. That's the enemy's whole strategy in two words. Keep you small. Keep you in the old name. Keep you believing you're just the guy who runs.

But you heard a different name. Maybe at camp. Maybe in the quiet since. Maybe you're still waiting to hear it, and that's okay. Your Father knows who you are, even on the days you don't.

The enemy doesn't get naming rights. He never did.

So here's what I want you to carry today. He doesn't get to name me.

It's Saturday, so take longer with Dad today. Ten minutes. Like that hour at camp, just shorter.

Ask Him where He wants to go. Let Him bring something to mind, something that happened, and the message that came with it. Find where you agreed with it. Break it out loud. Ask Him what's true. Then be quiet and write down what you hear.

If you get one, that's a good day. If nothing comes, that's okay too. You turned around. That's the fight.

He doesn't get to name you. Go be with your Father.

WITH DAD 10 MINUTES

Get quiet first. Then ask: *Father, which event would You like to take me to? What message did I hear?* Find where you agreed with it. Say it out loud: *I break the agreement that _____*. Ask: *Jesus, what is the truth?* Then listen, and write down what comes. If nothing comes, write down what you broke. You turned around. That counts.

SHARE

The trailers, Robin Hood, Robert the Bruce, or Neo in the subway: which moment from Saturday morning is sticking with you?

YOUR NOTES

AGAIN NEXT TUESDAY

READING

Six weeks home.

This week you walked back through Saturday morning. There's a real battle, and you don't have to be spooked to see it. The enemy works through messages. Accusation. Diminishment. His spin on real things. An agreement is when you take his word for it and start living from it.

And now you know what to do. Recognize. Break. Ask. Listen.

You also heard what most men never hear: you can say the word suicide, you can tell somebody, and you can stay with a brother who tells you.

Your notes from this week are right below. Read back through them.

Agreements don't only happen at camp, or way back in childhood. They happen on a Tuesday afternoon, after one email. That's fine. You know what to do. Do it again.

Today, rest.

And if one question is sitting with you, let it sit: *If the battle isn't the whole story, what else did He make me for?*

> **CARRY THIS**
>
> **Again next Tuesday.**

AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Let me paint you a picture of next Tuesday.
>
> It's about three in the afternoon. You're tired. Something small goes sideways. An email. A look from your wife. A number that didn't come in. And here it comes, right on time. Of course. You always do this. Nothing's ever going to change.
>
> That's not a big spiritual moment. That's Tuesday. And that's where most of this fight happens.
>
> The old way, you agree with it without even noticing. You carry it home and snap at your kids. Or go quiet. Or reach for the phone.

The new way, you catch it. That's not me. You say it, under your breath if you have to. I break the agreement that nothing's going to change. Jesus, what's true? And you give Him ten seconds of quiet.

That's it. No big production. You might have to do it again at five. That's fine. You're not failing. You're fighting.

So here's what I want you to carry into this week. Again next Tuesday.

And if this was a week you didn't break a single thing, that's okay. You're still learning to hear the difference. Keep listening.

Today, rest. Read back through your notes. Text one of the guys and ask how he's really doing.

And sit with that question. If the battle isn't the whole story, what else did He make me for?

We'll start there tomorrow. Again next Tuesday.

WITH DAD 3 MINUTES

Ask Him: *Father, what did You say to me this week that I want to keep?* Then just be with Him.

SHARE

One line about your sixth week home.

YOUR WEEK IN THE APP: HIS NOTES FROM DAYS 36 TO 42, FILLED IN

Same as Day 7: each note he wrote this week, with the day, the "Carry this" line, and the With Dad question. Only days he wrote show up.

YOUR NOTES ON DAY 42

SUNDAY EVENING, AFTER DAY 42

THE WEEK 6 EMAIL

Same template as Week 1. Only the seven day lines are new.

From: The Journey <jpulley@manaliveexpedition.com>
Subject: Week six is in the books. You're caught up.

Mike,

Six weeks home. Maybe you did every day. Maybe you missed a few. Either way, you're not behind, and there's nothing to apologize for. Here's the heart of the week, in case any of it slipped by.

Day 36, We Are at War. There's a real fight, and ignoring it doesn't get you out of it. No need to get spooky. Do your job: your job is your heart. Reread Day 36 ›

Day 37, Real Event, False Spin. The wound is what happened. The message is what you were told it means. They're not the same thing. Reread Day 37 ›

Day 38, Robert Sat Down. The enemy's best lies sound reasonable, and they sound like you. Sounds like me. Isn't me. Reread Day 38 ›

Day 39, Break It Out Loud. Recognize. Break. Ask. Listen. Simple enough to use on a Tuesday afternoon. Reread Day 39 ›

Day 40, When the Battle Goes Dark. Men like us can struggle with suicide, and you can tell somebody. If you're worried about a brother, ask him straight, and stay. Call or text 988 any time. Reread Day 40 ›

Day 41, Beginning to Believe. Neo kept getting hit and kept fighting, because he stopped answering to the old name. He doesn't get to name you. Reread Day 41 ›

Day 42, Again Next Tuesday. Agreements happen on ordinary afternoons. You know what to do now. Do it again. Reread Day 42 ›

Your notes from this week are waiting for you on Day 42. Only you can see them.

Read your week ›

That's the week. If you just read this, you're caught up. Tomorrow we start fresh.

Strength and Honor,
Pulley

FOR YOUR REVIEW

DECISIONS MADE IN THIS DRAFT

- **One section of the session per day, in camp order.** Day 36 the trailers and "we are at war," Day 37 wound, message, agreement, Day 38 Braveheart with accusation and diminishment, Day 39 the breaking process, Day 41 The Matrix subway, Day 42 the landing. Standing in the Way of Freedom sits inside Days 36 and 38. Robin Hood gets one line on Day 39 ("Rise and rise again"), as the courage it takes to break an agreement that feels true.
- **When the Battle Goes Dark is one day, Day 40 (Friday),** right after the practice day, the way it followed Battle at camp. It is a first-response and brotherhood day: men like us can struggle with this, say the word, tell somebody, ask directly, don't fix, stay, bring help close, follow up, he's still your brother. It uses the session's own five words (Ask. Stay. Safe. Connect. Follow.) and no other framework. No story slot. Tyson Fury is named only as hidden suffering; no details of his crisis.
- **988 is in the Day 40 reading, audio, and email line.** The reading also says "If you might act on it right now, call 988 or 911, or get to someone near you." That wording comes from ManAlive's own coach guidance for a man who discloses. Confirm you want 911 named on that page, or cut it to 988 only.
- **Placeholder to replace:** "[Link: ManAlive suicide resources page, coming]" is a line in the Day 40 reading, so it will load into the app as-is if not replaced first. Swap in the real link before this week goes live.
- **No named contact on Day 40.** Camp had the 1:00 conversation and named leaders. The app doesn't invent names. If you want a real ManAlive person or number listed, give it to me.
- **Locked language only:** wound, message, agreement, truth; "I break the agreement that _____"; "Jesus, what is the truth?" No legal-contract or courtroom-of-heaven language (one older talk used it; the current spec rules it out). Out loud is "not magic."
- **Authority anchored in Christ** (Day 39): "It's Christ's, and He gave it to you as His son." Not self-made, not swagger.
- **Saturday's 10 minutes is a short Battle Covenant of Silence,** using its own questions: "Which event would You like to take me to? What message did I hear?"
- **Four story slots** (Days 37, 38, 39, 41). Day 39 is your Battle story, the heart of the session: keep the event short, the agreement in one sentence, and don't end on "never struggled again." Days 36, 40, and 42 use coaching, the camp moment, and a Tuesday-afternoon picture.

- **Jail story:** offered once, as an optional part of the Day 41 slot ("when you stopped running and turned around"). Use it only if it fits. The script works either way.
- **No held stories used.** None were assigned to Week 6. Responders' stories from the transcripts (Chic, Dave, Steve) are not used.
- **Day 42 bridge:** "If the battle isn't the whole story, what else did He make me for?" points toward An Adventure to Live without teaching it.
- **Day 40 reading runs about 180 words,** longer than the others, to fit the 988 lines. Day 36's "Above all else, guard your heart" is Proverbs 4:23, unreferenced.

OVERALL NOTES ON WEEK 6